



OPEN
Compute Project

Foundation Staff Project

OCP Terminology Guidelines for Inclusion and Openness

Version C

Effective March 13, 2026

Table of Contents

1	Introduction	5
2	Scope	6
3	General Documentation	7
3.1	Racial Language	7
3.2	Gendered Language	7
3.3	Violence or War Language	8
4	Signal Names & Pin Names	9
5	License	10

List of Tables

1	Racial Language	7
2	Gendered Language	8
3	Violence or War Language	8
4	Signal & Pin Names	9

Revision History

Revision	Date	Author(s)	Description
A	unknown	William Carter (OCP)	Initial Release
B	2020/12/20	William Carter (OCP), Dell Technologies Inclusive Language Team	Added alternative language substitutions and section covering gendered language
C	TBD	Russ Wunderlich (OCP)	created md from rev B PDF. moved preferred term to 1st item in the list. Updated terms in racial language section. Removed Rule-of-thumb from gendered language. added violence & war section

1 Introduction

The ideals behind open sourcing stipulate that everyone benefits when we share and work together. Any open source project is designed to promote collaborative sharing of design elements with peers and to help each other learn from, adopt, or enhance shared contributions in a professional and inclusive manner. The Open Compute Project Foundation (OCP) operates within these ideals, and therefore requires that terminology that could be considered offensive be eliminated from any material.

2 Scope

Deprecated Terminology should be removed from all material contributed or shared with the Open Compute Project Community. This includes all material or presentations shared during project calls, workshops and Summit events. The preferred terminology shall be applied to all community material including documentation, specifications, white papers and presentations.

Specifically examples include:

- Schematics: Change pins on devices to the appropriate preferred name. Use net and signal names that avoid the use of terminology listed in the deprecated terminology column below.
- Hardware: Replace deprecated terminology with preferred terminology silkscreen labels.
- Software / Firmware: Add new function names using the preferred terminology. Maintaining reverse compatibility with deprecated names is allowed.
- Datasheets / Documentation: Use preferred terminology for general documentation and any pin and signal names listed within the documentation.

3 General Documentation

3.1 Racial Language

Table 1: Racial Language

Deprecated Terminology	Preferred Terminology	Typical Usage
Whitelist, White List, Whitelisted, Whitelisting	allowlist, include, accept, allow, Unblocked list, Permit list, Accept list, Inclusions	A list of devices, people or things considered to be acceptable or trustworthy. Example: "the software creates an Allow List of known good senders."
Blacklist, Black List, Blacklisted, Blacklisting	blocklist, denylist, deny list, block, exclude, reject, Banned list, Rejected list, Exclusions	A list of devices, people, or things considered to be unacceptable or not trustworthy.
Blackhat, Black hat	Malicious actor, Threat actor, unethical hacker	A hacker who infiltrates a computer system for malicious purposes.
Whitehat, White hat	ethical hacker, security researcher	An ethical computer hacker or a computer security expert who ensures the security of information systems.
Segregate, Segregation	separate, separation	Division of software or circuits into distinct elements or functions.
Blackout	outage, restrict, restriction	Failure of electrical system. Suppression of information.
Master	primary, source, controller, main, writer, control, local, parent, manager, superior, original	An IC or firmware/software device which has control over one or many other devices
Slave	secondary, target, responder, completer, reader, remote, agent, child, subordinate	An IC or firmware/software device which is controlled by another device
Master/Slave or Master-Slave (Includes any reference to both words in an implied relationship)	primary-secondary, requester-completer, source-target, primary-subordinate, parent-child	IC or firmware/software devices which has control over one or many and which is controlled by another.

3.2 Gendered Language

Table 2: Gendered Language

Deprecated Terminology	Preferred Terminology	Usage
Man-hour, man-day, and other derivatives, including plural forms	person-hour, person-day, fte-hour, fte-day, work-hour, work-day, human effort – and plural forms	Amount of work that can be done by one person within a period of time.
Manpower	workers, workforce, staff, labor, staffing	Numbers of persons available for work.
male, female	plug, socket	when used to reference a particular side of a mated pair connector
man-in-the-middle	Adversary-in-the-middle attack, Intermediary attack, Interceptor attack	When an attacker secretly intercepts and relays communications between two systems or people who believe that they are communicating directly with each other

27 3.3 Violence or War Language

Table 3: Violence or War Language

Deprecated Terminology	Preferred Terminology	Usage
abort, aborted, kill, killed	end/ended, halt, cancel, interrupt, stop/stopped	intentionally stopping, halting, or ending a process, operation, or task before it completes
blast-radius	impact scope, span of effect, extent, affected areas, affected components	the span of impact from a particular error or incident
End-of-life	end of support, decommission, discontinued support	the point at which a product or service is no longer supported, maintained, or updated

4 Signal Names & Pin Names

Table 4: Signal & Pin Names

Deprecated Terminology	Preferred Terminology	Usage
SS – Slave Select	CS – Chip Select	Activated by the controller to initiate communication with a given peripheral.
MOMI – Master Out Master In SOSI – Slave Out Slave In	COPI (controller out / peripheral in)	For devices that can be either a controller or a peripheral; the signal on which the device sends output when acting as the controller, and receives input when acting as the peripheral.
MOMI – Master Out Master In SOSI – Slave Out Slave In	CIPO (controller in / peripheral out)	For devices that can be either a controller or a peripheral; the signal on which the device receives input when acting as the controller, and sends output when acting as the peripheral.
MOSI – Master Out Slave In	SDI (Serial Data In)	An input signal on a device where data is received from another SPI device.
MISO – Master In Slave Out	SDO (Serial Data Out)	An output signal on a device where data is sent out to another SPI device.

5 License

OCP encourages participants to share their proposals, specifications and designs with the community. This is to promote openness and encourage continuous and open feedback. It is important to remember that by providing feedback for any such documents, whether in written or verbal form, that the contributor or the contributor's organization grants OCP and its members irrevocable right to use this feedback for any purpose without any further obligation.

It is acknowledged that any such documentation and any ancillary materials that are provided to OCP in connection with this document, including without limitation any white papers, articles, photographs, studies, diagrams, contact information (together, "Materials") are made available under the [Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International License](#), or any later version, and without limiting the foregoing, OCP may make the Materials available under such terms.

As a contributor to this document, all members represent that they have the authority to grant the rights and licenses herein. They further represent and warrant that the Materials do not and will not violate the copyrights or misappropriate the trade secret rights of any third party, including without limitation rights in intellectual property. The contributor(s) also represent that, to the extent the Materials include materials protected by copyright or trade secret rights that are owned or created by any third-party, they have obtained permission for its use consistent with the foregoing. They will provide OCP evidence of such permission upon OCP's request. This document and any "Materials" are published on the respective project's wiki page and are open to the public in accordance with [OCP's Bylaws and IP Policy](#). If you have any questions please contact OCP.